

Teaching Design Check

Eleven questions your education lead should be able to answer before anyone books a room. Simple to ask. Hard to answer well. You don't have to answer every row yourself, but you need to know someone can. If nobody can, you've found the gap.

How to use it. Tick a box for each row and write one line on *where's the evidence?* A tick without a note doesn't count.

The programme (Teaching That Lands): ● taught · ① touched on · ○ not covered. Where a row is ○ and it matters, involve someone who knows that area. Don't skip the row.

Lots of gaps? Start here. Pick one session and one row to start. Organisations change slowly: expect years, not weeks.

1. **Start:** rows 1, 4, 10. Three questions on every request.
2. **Next:** rows 2, 5, 6, 7. Better sessions: what the programme teaches.
3. **Then:** rows 3, 8, 9, 11. The system: needs an education lead. Basic accessibility can't wait.

BEFORE

1 Is teaching the answer?

Start · ①

What should people do differently, what would show it, and why don't they do it now?

CONSIDER Would they do it if their job depended on it? Then it isn't skill: look at kit, staffing, workload, the form, the culture. Would a checklist, a pocket card or a process change do it instead? Cost: people × hours, plus travel and backfill.

RED FLAGS *The request arrives as a format ("a study day on X"). The date is set before the problem is.*

☐ ✓ ☐ ~ ☐ ✗ ☐ N/A Evidence: _____

2 Learners and context

Next · ○

Who exactly, how many, and what can they already do?

CONSIDER What they've been taught before. Nights, part-time and bank staff; staff educated overseas; English as an additional language; neurodivergent learners. Do they know why it matters? Choosing to come, or sent? Do some groups do less well now?

RED FLAGS *"All staff". Nobody has spoken to a learner. Mandatory for everyone, whatever they can already do.*

☐ ✓ ☐ ~ ☐ ✗ ☐ N/A Evidence: _____

3 Co-production

Then · ○

Who shaped this, apart from the person who asked for it?

CONSIDER Two or three learners and their managers. Patients or carers where care is affected (budget for their time and expenses). Whoever will deliver it. Something that already exists.

RED FLAGS *Designed in a meeting with no learners in it. A patient story used as decoration, not as a voice.*

☐ ✓ ☐ ~ ☐ ✗ ☐ N/A Evidence: _____

4 Outcomes

Start · ● Session 3

One to three things people will be able to do, with verbs you could watch?

CONSIDER Which level of Miller's pyramid does each reach? Can a "does" outcome be reached in one session? Some ideas take time to click.

RED FLAGS *"Understand", "be aware of", "appreciate". Ten outcomes for an hour.*

☐ ✓ ☐ ~ ☐ ✗ ☐ N/A Evidence: _____

5 Who's teaching it?

Next · ○

Who will deliver it, are they prepared and supported, and who other than the designer has checked it?

CONSIDER Protected time to prepare. Do they know the subject *and* how to teach it? A colleague to observe and give feedback. Their own development: a teaching qualification, or Advance HE Fellowship (professional recognition for teaching).

RED FLAGS *The subject expert is told to "do a session" with no time to prepare. The designer is the only one who checked it.*

☐ ✓ ☐ ~ ☐ ✗ ☐ N/A Evidence: _____

6 Format and activities

Next · ● Session 2 (activities) · ○ (format)

Is a session the right shape? Will learners practise the outcome, somewhere it's safe to get it wrong?

CONSIDER A huddle, simulation, teaching on the job, e-learning, or a pocket card? Short sessions spread out, or one day? Realistic practice with room for mistakes; a briefing before and a debrief after. Other professions in the room? Games: the quiz works because of retrieval, not the points.

RED FLAGS *The agenda is a list of speakers. "E-learning, so it's done." A game nobody can link to an outcome.*

☐ ✓ ☐ ~ ☐ ✗ ☐ N/A Evidence: _____
7 Slides and materials

Next · ● Session 1

Does every slide earn its place? Is the clinical content right and up to date?

CONSIDER Cut the clutter; a picture with your voice. A one-page summary or pocket card instead of printed slides? Checked against current policy and guidance by whoever owns it. Permission for every image.

RED FLAGS *60 slides for an hour. The slides are the handout. Nobody knows which version of the policy they teach.*

☐ ✓ ☐ ~ ☐ ✗ ☐ N/A Evidence: _____
8 Accessible and inclusive

Then (basics now) · ● Session 1

Can everyone take part fully, and benefit equally?

CONSIDER Adjustments asked about beforehand. Plain language, captions, transcripts, dyslexia-friendly materials; e-learning to WCAG 2.1 AA. Timing for night staff; the cost of attending. An equality impact assessment, if you use them.

RED FLAGS *"Tell us on the day if you need anything." A video with no captions.*

☐ ✓ ☐ ~ ☐ ✗ ☐ N/A Evidence: _____
9 Assessment, if needed

Then · ● Session 3 (evidence) · ○ (formal)

Does it need assessing? If so, does the check match the outcome, and is it fair?

CONSIDER A check to help people learn, or to sign them off? Who owns the sign-off, and are they prepared to assess? Do some groups do worse on it?

RED FLAGS *A quiz used to sign off a "does" outcome. A sign-off with nobody prepared to assess.*

☐ ✓ ☐ ~ ☐ ✗ ☐ N/A Evidence: _____

AFTER

10 Back at work

Start · ● Session 3 (after) · ● (before)

Will the workplace let people use it, soon, and keep them to it?

CONSIDER **Before:** managers know what's taught and what they'll support; learners know why they're going. **After:** a chance to use it within days; revisit at 30, 60 and 90 days; a named person and the support they've agreed.

RED FLAGS *Success means attendance and smile sheets. "We'll email the slides." Managers hear about it afterwards, if at all.*

☐ ✓ ☐ ~ ☐ ✗ ☐ N/A Evidence: _____
11 Keep it alive

Then · ○

Who owns it, how will it improve, and when is it next reviewed?

CONSIDER Run it once with a small group first. Evaluate *the session*, not only the learners, and change it. A named content owner and a review date; who takes over if they leave?

RED FLAGS *The same slides for five years. No review date. The only person who knows the plan is moving on.*

☐ ✓ ☐ ~ ☐ ✗ ☐ N/A Evidence: _____
Sign-off

Designed by _____

Checked by (not the designer) _____

Date · review date _____

Decision: ☐ Go ☐ Go with changes ☐ Not a teaching problem: pass to _____